PROGRAM LESSON 1 · 90 MINUTES · SCRIPT FOR PRACTICE

Lesson 1: Story & Mini Book

Every student writes their whole story on the Mini Book pages.

Goal by the end of this lesson: Mini Book complete · 0 book pages yet

Practice tip: read each line aloud three times. Tick a box each time you practice: ☐ ☐ ☐

Welcome

1	Welcome, Young Authors!
2	Today is a very exciting day, because today we begin creating a real book.
3	Raise your hand if you have ever written a story before.
4	Wonderful. Whether this is your first story or your hundredth story, every author starts the same way: with an idea.
5	At Tiny Star, we don't just write stories. We become creators.
6	Let's take one minute to get our minds ready.

Young Author Meditation

1	Sit comfortably.
2	Close your eyes if you would like.
3	Take a slow breath in.
4	And slowly breathe out.
5	Imagine opening a magical door.
6	Behind the door is your story.
7	Who is there?
8	What do they look like?
9	What adventure is waiting for them?
10	Take one more deep breath.
11	When you are ready, open your eyes.
12	Today we begin bringing that story to life.

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Classroom rules

1	Before we begin, let's review our classroom rules. At Tiny Star, we have four important rules.
2	Number one: Respect. We respect ourselves, others, and our creative materials.
3	Number two: Listening. When someone is speaking, we listen.
4	Number three: Asking. If you have a question or would like to share, raise your hand.
5	Number four: Try our best. We do not need to be perfect. We simply try our best every day.
6	When you try your best, you can earn six types of stickers. Let's see how many stickers you can win today!

Teacher Lecture: the 3 Acts Method

1	Today I am going to teach you a storytelling secret that many authors use. It is called the 3 Acts Method.
2	Most stories have three parts.
3	Act 1 is the beginning. This is where we meet the character. Who is the character? Where are they? When does the story happen? What are they doing?
4	Act 2 is the problem. Then something happens. A problem appears. If there is no problem, there is usually no story.
5	Act 3: solve the problem. The character tries one way. It doesn't work. They try another way. It doesn't work. They try a third way. This time it works!
6	And at the ending, we ask one final question: what did the character learn?

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Example story: Jen and Rubby

1	Jen is a dark-colored puppy with big round eyes. He is happily playing with his favorite toy, Rubby.
2	When playtime is over, Jen cannot find Rubby. He looks everywhere. He starts to worry.
3	First, Jen searches around the house. But he cannot find Rubby.
4	Next, he searches in the yard. He sees many things, but not Rubby.
5	Finally, he notices a clue near the bedroom window. He looks under the brush. There is Rubby! The problem is solved.
6	What did Jen learn? Jen learns to be responsible and to put away his favorite toy after playing.

Guiding WHO, WHEN, WHERE, WHAT, PROBLEM (one at a time)

1	Who is in your story? Is your character a human or an animal? What is their name? How old are they? What are they wearing?
2	If you finish your WHO, raise your hand.
3	When does your story happen? Is it morning, afternoon or evening? What time is it? What season?
4	Where does your story happen? At home? At school? Which room? What does it look like?
5	What is your character doing when the story begins, before the problem appears?
6	Now, what problem happens in your story? Take your time. Think. Then write it down.

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Teacher Lecture: the Mini Book

1	Now that you all have your characters, we will write your story on these Mini Book pages.
2	These pages are your book's mini model. Today you will write your story on pages 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15 and 17.
3	Step 1: find the star sign. Only write your story in the boxes with the star.
4	Step 2: when you finish writing your story, raise your hand.
5	Step 3: I will check your grammar, spelling, story development and missing details.

Creating in Silence

1	Now we're going to play a game called Creating in Silence.
2	For the next ten minutes, our classroom will be completely quiet so everyone can focus on their own ideas.
3	Remember: no talking.
4	If you have a question, write it on your note sheet, then quietly raise your hand. I'll come help you.
5	Take a deep breath, and let the silence help your imagination. Ready? Let's begin!

Reflection

1	Today we took the first step toward becoming published authors.
2	Raise your hand if you discovered a story today.
3	If your Mini Book is not finished yet, please finish it at home before our next class.
4	Next week we will begin to illustrate your story. You can research what your characters look like before the next class.
5	Remember: great books don't start perfectly. Great books start with an idea in your mind, written on paper.
6	Let's give ourselves a round of applause. Authors, thank you for your hard work today!

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Cleanup & dismissal

1	Authors, it's time to clean up.
2	Please put your pages in your folder.
3	Pencils, markers and erasers go back in the pencil boxes.
4	Please clean your table and the floor under your table.
5	Now let's line up quietly. I will dismiss each of you to your grown-up.

Phone call to a parent (when a student is behind)

1	Hi, is this [Parent's Name]? This is [Your Name], [Student]'s Tiny Star teacher. Do you have two minutes?
2	First, I want to tell you something great: [one specific positive from today].
3	This week, every young author is working on finishing the Mini Book, which means writing the whole story in the 9 boxes. [Student] has finished [what is done], and still needs [what is left].
4	In class, I [support you gave]. At home, the most helpful thing is [one simple step].
5	Does that sound doable this week? Is there anything that makes it hard for [Student] right now?
6	Thank you so much. I'm also sending a short email with the details. See you next week!

Text message to a parent

Hi [Parent's Name], this is [Your Name], [Student]'s Tiny Star teacher. [Student] did great work today! This week's goal is a finished Mini Book (the whole story in 9 boxes), and [he/she] still needs to finish [what's left]. I just emailed you a few simple tips. Could you help [him/her] finish before Lesson 2? Thank you!

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